SINCE AI HACKATHON 2026 · FONECTA CHALLENGE

Connect Suggests – Customer Approves

No customer walks to a closed door. And no owner has to log in to stop it.

Flovr · Alex, Vova and Zahar (Flovr's AI agent) · synthetic Fonecta dataset only

THE PROBLEM

Owners don't log in. So the hours go wrong exactly when it matters.

53%

of the 2025 pilot suggestions got **no reply at all** (1,610 of 3,031).

65% / 40%

reply rate on WhatsApp vs email in the same pilot. The channel matters as much as the suggestion.

~40%

of needed changes have **no usable history** to copy (Fonecta's own note). That's where it gets hard.

Source: pilot_decision_log_2025.csv and the starter kit README, in the challenge dataset.

THE SOLUTION

The whole chain, working

1. **Detect:** a model over every business × special day: own history, shopping centre, peers, last year's activity, closed-door reviews, Google user edits.
2. **Suggest:** the hours candidate with the best track record. Confident → suggest, unsure → ask, weak → stay quiet.
3. **Contact:** one message in the owner's language (fi/sv/nb/en) and channel. Every date says what Google shows now and why it's wrong.
4. **Decide:** no login. Approve / Edit / No thanks, plus "handle holidays for me".
5. **Apply:** written to Yext, then a confirmation of where it shows and how soon, plus a preview.



RELIABILITY

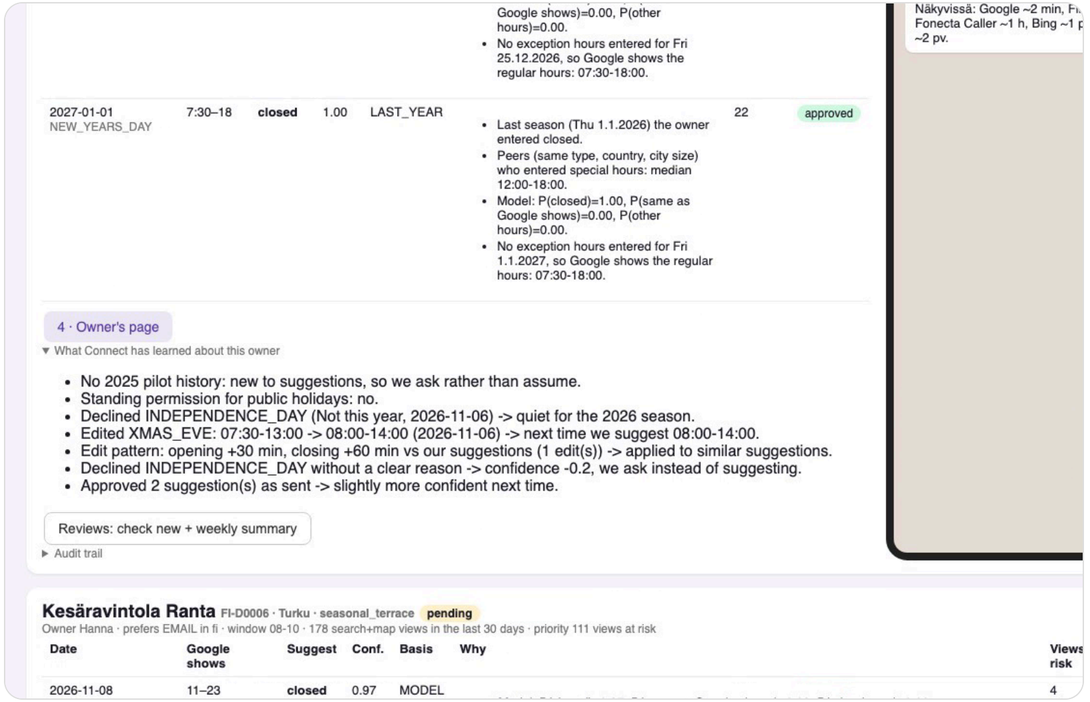
The customer always has the last word

- Nothing reaches Yext without an owner decision, a standing permission (public holidays, confident only, followed by an inform message with one-tap **Undo**) or an undo. That's enforced in code and unit-tested.
- Unsure → we **ask**, never assume (new customer with no history: questions, not guesses).
- Looks closed for good → **flagged to a human**, no message.
- Hours already right → **silence**.
- No answer → backup approver after 24 h → one **urgent call** when it's 48 h away. The call never approves anything.
- Every suggestion keeps its reasons, the message and the answer: a full **audit trail**.

HOW IT LEARNS

Every answer makes the next suggestion better

- **Edit** → remembered for that day, and the pattern (e.g. +1 h) applies to similar days.
- **"Open as usual" / "Not this year"** → that day goes quiet.
- **No reason given** → lower confidence: next time we ask instead of suggest.
- **Standing permission** → applied, then the owner is informed.
- 2025 pilot decisions seed each owner's history from day one.



Screenshot: the live ops console after the demo owner edited Christmas Eve and declined Independence Day ("Not this year").

RESULTS · FONECTA'S SCORING SCRIPT

Better than the baseline, on businesses the model never saw

	Score	Exact precision	Recall	Search views protected	Harmful
Baseline (kit)	54.5	0.90	0.59	57%	224
Ours (5-fold by business)	**61.8**	0.84	**0.70**	**69%**	396

The honest part: we find far more of the wrong hours, at the cost of more wrong-state guesses. In the product, anything under 0.6 confidence becomes a **question** rather than a suggestion, and nothing is published without the owner.

Dev split 2026, out-of-fold. predictions_2026.csv (all target rows) is in the repo for the hidden test split.

EXTENSIBILITY + LIVE DATA

One loop, many jobs

- **Reviews:** a bad review gets a reply drafted in its language → owner posts / edits / skips → Yext Reviews API. Plus a weekly "what people praised" summary.
- **Live events** (bonus): Helsinki LinkedEvents, live. A concert 650 m away ends 20:15 → "Stay open till 21:15?". 5 of 106 Helsinki restaurants got one this weekend. No attendance data is the gap.
- **WhatsApp:** 3 reply buttons, a template for business-initiated messages, a webhook.
- **Ready for Yext's own Suggestions API**: the apply step is pluggable (APPLY_MODE), so approvals can live inside Yext.

NEXT STEPS

From demo to December

- Pilot with Connect customers before Christmas: WhatsApp-first, measure the reply rate against 2025's 47%.
- Get the WhatsApp utility template approved in fi/sv/nb/en.
- Write approvals through Yext Suggestions (needs that API enabled on our sandbox).
- Add attendance data (ticketing / venues) to the event signal. Norway launch: MET + local calendars.

github.com/zahar-io/fonecta · demo video: 2 min, real app